He addressed the Indian diaspora via videoconference in March where he spoke passionately of how secularism for him meant ‘India First’. At the *India Today* conclave in March, he spoke of the Gujarat model and his ‘Namo Mantra’—how he had used technology to reduce inefficiency in government, and offered solutions to issues like power crisis and water management. When a journalist tried to ask a question on Gujarat 2002, Modi looked at him sternly and avoided a direct answer, pointing out that the SIT had cleared him. ‘Looks like some people will not change,’ was the terse response when the questioner persisted.

In April, he went down south to the Sivagiri Mutt in Kerala to address religious leaders there; the same week, he was flying north to Ramdev’s Patanjali Yoga Peeth. But even while addressing the Sadhu Samaj at Ramdev’s set-up, there was no trace of the majoritarian agenda of 2002. Instead, Modi spoke with telling effect on the need to blend spirituality with science and technology. As he referred to a benign and universal Hindu identity and consciousness, he sounded more like Vivekananda than a BJP politician.

Modi switched easily from one target audience to another. He spoke to NRIs across twenty cities in the US on Gujarat Foundation Day. He used Facebook to crowdsource ideas while speaking to Pune’s Fergusson College students on the need to reform education. He addressed a book release function of RSS activist Vinay Sahasrabuddhe at the Bombay Stock Exchange where the gathering of traders and karyakartas was lectured on the Gandhi model of trusteeship and its links to good governance. At a Google+ Hangout, he spoke on politics and technology, and gave his formula for success: IT + IT = IT (Indian Talent plus Indian Technology equals India Tomorrow). The one-liners were headline grabbing even if there was a tendency to get the facts wrong at times—for example, Modi wrongly claimed that China had spent 20 per cent of its GDP on education. Each event played out live on television and the Internet. ‘We just wanted to keep him in the news by getting him to share his ideas with different constituencies across urban India and even global audiences,’ says a Team Modi member.